



[BIT703 Web Technologies](#) / [Contents](#) / Topic 6: Client-side web application development – CSS / Understanding CSS

Animations 15m

The CSS animation feature allows us to progressively and smoothly change the style of an element. It uses the `@keyframes` rule to control the timing at each keyframe of an animation. We can fast forward, reverse, rewind and even loop infinitely.

There are several animation properties, including `animation-name` that allows the binding of the `@keyframes` animation to an element. Other properties include `animation-duration`, which specifies the duration of the animation and `animation-direction`, which specifies how the animation will be played: forwards, backwards or in alternating cycles.

Note: It is not a good idea to use too many animations in your pages as they can make the page distracting or even reduce accessibility. Small and short animations are good for creating notifications to attract the reader's attention.

In Example 6.21 below, we have used the `@keyframes`, `animation-duration`, `animation-name` and `animation-iteration-count` properties to gradually change the colour and font size of the text.



[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

CSS

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

p {
 animation-duration: 10s;
 animation-name: example;
 animation-iteration-count:
infinite;
}
@keyframes example {
 0% {color:red;font-size: 16px; }
 25% {color:purple; font-size:
32px;}
 50% {color:blue; font-size:
64px;}
 75% {color:green; font-size:
128px;}
 100% {color:red;font-size: 260px;
}
}

Resources

1x 0.5x 0.25x

Rerun

Example 6.21 Animation



[Skip to main content](#)

Dig deeper

W3Schools provides an excellent reference for CSS animation properties in CSS Animations (W3Schools, n.d.).



Finally, let's look at CSS frameworks, powerful tools that simplify and speed up the process of building responsive and modern web designs



Thoughts on this page?

